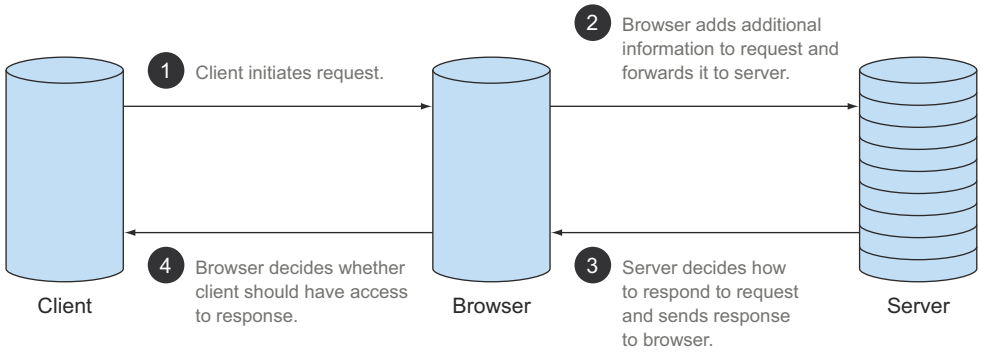


Figure 3.12 Lifecycle of a CORS request

1. The client initiates the request.
2. The browser adds additional information to the request and forwards it to the server.
3. The server decides how to respond to the request, and sends the response to the browser.
4. The browser decides whether the client should have access to the response, and either passes the response to the client or returns an error.

Like an ATM interacting with a bank account, the browser and the server "talk" to each other to determine whether the client can access the server's data. A hypothetical conversation between the browser and the server might go something like figure 3.13.

The browser and the server talk to each other through HTTP headers. HTTP headers carry the details of the CORS request, including whether or not the CORS request is allowed. Let's take another look at the conversation in figure 3.13, this time mapped onto a set of HTTP requests and responses. The bolded items show how the parts of the conversation map to the HTTP headers.

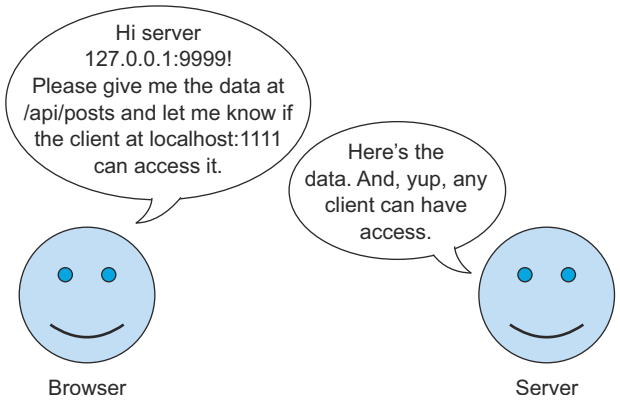


Figure 3.13 Conversation between a browser and a server regarding CORS